professor at Queens College. Boyd had been corresponding with me all through my stay in the Army and I was eager to meet him.

I made my way out to Queens and spent the day with him and the Sards from 2:00 p.m. to 10:00 p.m. This included an elaborate and rather formal dinner, for in my diary I remarked on the fact that the salad was mixed in a large wooden bowl, that the chicken was carved by Dr. Sard, and that there were lit candles on the table. I had never encountered such articles of sophistication before.

Boyd himself was forty-three at the time, a stocky fellow of about my height who (in my opinion) looked like H. G. Wells. We liked each other.

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On Monday, September 23, 1946, I registered at Columbia again, just as though the 4 1 /2-year lapse had never been. I had left a young man of twenty-two; I came back nearly twenty-seven. Had I not been interrupted, I might conceivably have earned my doctorate at the age of twenty-four, which would have been more in accord with my child-prodigy status; but now that could never be. Tens of millions of people had suffered far worse than I did in the course of World War II—but when no one was looking, I sometimes mourned the four-year delay.

But at least I had done all my necessary coursework before I had left Columbia. Now it was only necessary to do research and nothing more.

On October 1, I was assigned a research room and started in from the beginning. I discovered, rather ruefully, that in the war years, Linus Pauling's theory of resonance had taken over organic chemistry completely so that I was virtually a beginner again and would have to learn the subject afresh.

I was asked to be lab assistant at a small salary, but I refused. I dared lose no further time from my research—and I didn't need the money.

I am ashamed to say I felt a small glow of mean triumph. When I had started research before leaving for the Navy Yard, I had asked to be a lab assistant because at that time I needed the money—and they had refused me. Well, now J refused them.

Now that I was in New York, bits of the past floated up. Gerry Cohen, my most reliable companion in basic training, showed up in our apartment on a visit on October 5. He was still in the Army and regaled us for three hours